She needed water, both to drink and clean her knee. Her mother's voice in her head told her that soap and water, applied to all wounds, no matter how small, stopped an infection.

"May I go to the toilet first?" She asked, pointing to her knee.

He glared. "This isn't a hotel. Toilets are all locked up until the morning."

Léa pressed her lips together. Her mouth parched, throat tight with dread. She could hold off until the morning. Maybe in the cabin she'd find water or a sink. She limped past the cabins and arrived at the one with a black F painted on a white square.

She opened the door. A single light bulb hung from the ceiling, and a stove was in the center of the room, with a table and chairs where a woman sat alone, sewing. Two corridors led off the main room—maybe there were more rooms in the back. She couldn't hear any voices coming from inside them, so everyone must be asleep.

The woman got up and approached Léa. "Who are you?"

"I was told to come here for a bed."

The woman scratched her head. "You shouldn't be coming here at this hour and we have no extra beds. Who sent you?"

"The gendarme said cabin F . . . Is there a toilet or a sink I could use?"

"Outside, but they lock them at night." The woman bent down, nodding at Léa's knee. "You're lucky I don't sleep. I've got some water to clean that. You're probably thirsty, too."

"Yes," Léa said, her throat cottony.

She motioned to a chair. "Wait here. I'll be back."

Léa thanked her and sat down. The woman returned with a glass of water. Then she brought a bowl of water, a bar of soap and a rag. Léa drank, the liquid cooling her burning throat. Then she set about cleaning her knee.

"You can share with me tonight," the woman said. "I'm Edith. What's your name?"

"Léa. Thank you for the water and for helping me."

"After you've rested a little, you'll need to find another cabin." Edith's brown eyes scanned Léa's face. "As I said, there's no room for you here."

Léa nodded, though in her gut, she suspected none of the other cabins would have room for her either. She bit her lower lip and told herself she'd figure it out.